

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 6
♥ Q J 9 2
♦ K 7 4
♣ 9 7 3

♠ K 9 4

♥ A 6 3

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ A Q 4



♠ Q J 7 3 2

♥ 10 7

♦ 6 5

♣ J 10 8 2

♠ 10 5

♥ K 8 5 4

♦ A 10 9 3

♣ K 6 5

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

the other suits. You don't care which he leads because you can now win 8 more tricks and make your contract.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠3. West wins the first trick with the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You can win 3 more ♦ tricks if the finesse works, but even if it doesn't work you can still get the 2 that you need. Of course if West does win the ♦K it would sure be great if he had no ♠ to lead. So you duck the second ♠ and take your ♠K when they play a third round.

After winning the ♠K you are conveniently in your hand, so you play the ♦Q and let it ride when East plays a low card. Alas, West takes the trick with his ♦K.

It's too bad the finesse didn't work, but it's not too too bad! Because West is out of ♠s and must lead one of

As long as you were going to finesse into West you could establish the ♦s without allowing East to gain the lead.

And as long as you had held up on the ♠K until the third round you could ensure that West was out of ♠s if he had started with only 3.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6
 ♥ A 10 9
 ♦ 7 5 2
 ♣ K J 10 6 4

♠ J 9 3 2

♥ Q 8 3

♦ 10 9 6

♣ A Q 3



♠ A K 7 5
 ♥ K J 7
 ♦ A 8 3
 ♣ 9 8 2

♠ 10 8 4

♥ 6 5 4 2

♦ K Q J 4

♣ 7 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Win with dummy's ♠Q and force out the ♣A.

The rest of the tricks are yours, nine in all.

If North had only held 2 ♦s it would have been OK to hold up your ♦A just once.

But with this layout you needed to hold up twice.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 6

You will need some ♣ tricks to make the contract. If South has 5 ♦s and also the ♣A then you will go down. It doesn't matter if he has the ♣Q because you can finesse him out of that.

But in the case where North has both the ♣ A Q you need to make sure he has no ♦ when he takes his first trick. So hold up the ♦A until the third round, everybody following.

Now start on the ♣s. Play your ♣9 and let it ride. North wins the ♣Q and returns a ♠. Good, he didn't have the fourth ♦.